

The Human-AI Partnership Framework

Where human judgment belongs

Procure-to-Pay

PCF 9.6 — AP, expense reimbursements & corporate cards — Value Stream Profile

This value stream comprises one APQC PCF process group: 9.6 Process Accounts Payable and Expense Reimbursements — spanning 3 Level 3 processes and 22 Level 4 activities.

At the activity level, this value stream's work breaks down as 16 Transaction activities — the highest concentration of any PCF 9.0 value stream — 3 Decision activities, 2 Document activities, and 1 Exception activity.

At M3 (HITL Design Intent), the value stream's aggregate human-involvement ratio is 44%, down from a 67% undesigned baseline — a 23-point AI convergence opportunity.

L3 PROCESSES	L4 ACTIVITIES	M1 BASELINE H%	M3 DESIGN INTENT H%	Δ M1 → M3
3	22	67%	44%	-23%

KPIs

Business Impact Metric & Formula (where confirmed)	Source
Cost per invoice processed <i>Total AP operating cost ÷ number of invoices processed per period</i>	APQC OSB
Touchless invoice rate <i>% of invoices processed with no manual intervention from receipt to payment</i>	The Hackett Group
Days Payable Outstanding (DPO) <i>(Accounts Payable ÷ Cost of Goods Sold) × Number of Days in Period</i>	APQC OSB
Expense report cycle time <i>Average calendar days from expense report submission to reimbursement</i>	APQC OSB

Design Narrative

Procure-to-Pay follows the same 2-of-3 pattern as Time-to-Pay: Director of Accounting holds Accountable for accounts payable (9.6.1) and expense reimbursements (9.6.2), while Treasury Manager owns the stream's third L3, corporate credit card management (9.6.3) — a natural Treasury carve-out since card programs are banking-relationship products even when the resulting spend flows through Accounting's payable process. This value stream carries the domain's highest concentration of Transaction-pattern activity (16 of 22 activities), reflecting how much of accounts-payable work is rules-based processing once a vendor invoice or expense claim is submitted, and it also carries one of PCF 9.0's four Exception-pattern activities (9.6.1.7, Research/Resolve payable exceptions). Its steepest AI-absorption opportunity sits in 9.6.2.1 (Establish and communicate expense reimbursement policies and approval limits, Document-pattern, -32 points).

AI Capability Map

Pattern-type distribution across this value stream's activity units. H% figures are the pattern type's standard value at each maturity level, applied consistently across all PCF domains.

Decision <i>Judgment & Authority — gates that stay human by design</i> 3 L4 activities M1 92% → M3 80%	Knowledge <i>Synthesis & Interpretation — judgment-driven work</i> 0 L4 activities <i>No activities of this pattern in this value stream</i>	Document <i>Content Generation — drafting and communication</i> 2 L4 activities M1 72% → M3 40%	Transaction <i>Rules-Based Processing — suited to automation</i> 16 L4 activities M1 60% → M3 35%	Exception <i>Non-Standard Resolution — human-resolved by nature</i> 1 L4 activities M1 95% → M3 82%
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Process Accountability

Process Accountability	Tier	L3 Processes	L4 Activities
Director of Accounting	Managerial	9.6.1, 9.6.2	16
Treasury Manager	Managerial	9.6.3	6

Handoff Points

Procure-to-Pay opens with Director of Accounting-accountable accounts payable (9.6.1) — matching, auditing, and approving vendor invoices for payment.

Expense reimbursements (9.6.2) run as a parallel Director of Accounting-owned lane for employee-submitted claims rather than vendor invoices, closing with the same approve-and-pay pattern.

Corporate credit card management (9.6.3) hands to Treasury Manager, who owns card issuance and limit management even though resulting transactions still settle through Director of Accounting's payable process.

Governed Decision Points

Every Decision/Exception-pattern activity in the value stream, including those embedded inside Mixed-labeled steps.

PCF	Decision	Authority	Impact	Escalates To	Trigger
9.6.1.4	Approve payments	Director of Accounting	Financial — releases company funds to a vendor	VP Controller (Executive)	Payment amount exceeds Director of Accounting's standing approval limit or the vendor lacks an approved master-file record
9.6.1.7	Research/Resolve payable exceptions	Director of Accounting	Financial — resolves a discrepancy blocking vendor payment	VP Controller (Executive)	Exception involves a disputed amount above policy threshold or a suspected duplicate/fraudulent invoice
9.6.3.5	Approve/Change credit limits	Treasury Manager	Financial — expands corporate card spending exposure	VP Treasury (Executive)	Requested limit increase exceeds Treasury Manager's standing authorization or the cardholder is outside standard risk profile